Dian Ji

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EDUCATION

2023 – Present	**Ph.D.**, Earth, Environmental and Planetary Sciences Rice University, Houston, USA Advisor: Rajdeep Dasgupta, Committee: Cin-Ty Lee, Bidong Zhang	GPA: 3.88 / 4.00
2021 – 2023	**M.Sc.**, Geology University of Tennessee, Knoxville, USA Advisor: Nicholas Dygert, Committee: Molly McCanta, Shichun Huang, Bradley Thomson Thesis: Numerical and Experimental Constraints on Trace Element Fractionation During Lunar Magma Ocean Solidification	GPA: 4.00 / 4.00
2016 – 2020	**B.E.**, Resource Exploration Engineering China University of Petroleum, Beijing, China Advisor: Huichuan Liu	

Google Scholar

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Total citations = 85; h-index = 5; i10-index = 3

9. **D. Ji,** R. Dasgupta, (2026) Garnet pyroxenite at mid-mantle depths as a source of young lunar magmatism. *Earth and Planetary Science Letter.* doi.org/10.1016/j.epsl.2026.120133
8. C.T. Lee, J. Zhang, D. Keller, Y. Zhang, **D. Ji**, J. Mou, (2026) Extreme magmatic differentiation and silicic magmatism without low melt fractions. *Lithos.* doi.org/10.1016/j.lithos.2026.108581
7. **D. Ji,** R. Dasgupta, C.T. Lee, (2026) The effects of magmatic recharge on primary lunar melt compositions: Implications for the water and other volatile budget of the Moon. *Geochimica et Cosmochimica Acta.* doi.org/ 10.1016/j.gca.2026.03.042
6. Y. Zhang, R. Dasgupta, **D. Ji**, C. Lee, Y. Peng, B. Charlier, Z. Jin, J. Chen, O. Namur, (2025) Mantle melting conditions of mare lavas on South Pole–Aitken basin of lunar farside. *Geophysical Research Letters.* doi.org/10.1029/2024GL112418
5. **D. Ji,** R. Dasgupta, (2025) Sulfur inventory of the young lunar mantle constrained by experimental sulfide saturation of Chang'e-5 mare basalts and a new sulfur solubility model for silicate melts in equilibrium with sulfides of variable metal–sulfur ratio. *Geochimica et Cosmochimica Acta.* doi.org/10.1016/j.gca.2025.02.019
4. N. Dygert, **D. Ji,** E. Etheridge, (2025) A predictive model for divalent element partitioning between clinopyroxene and basaltic melt and a europium-in-plagioclase-clinopyroxene oxybarometer for cumulate rocks. *Geochimica et Cosmochimica Acta*. doi.org/10.1016/j.gca.2025.02.003
3. **D. Ji,** N. Dygert, (2024) Trace element partitioning between apatite and silicate melts: Effects of major element composition, temperature, and oxygen fugacity, and implications for the volatile element budget of the lunar magma ocean. *Geochimica et Cosmochimica Acta*. doi: 10.1016/j.gca.2023.11.004
2. **D. Ji,** N. Dygert, (2023) Trace element evidence for serial processing of the lunar flotation crust and a depleted bulk Moon. *Earth and Planetary Science Letters.* doi: 10.1016/j.epsl.2022.117958
1. **D. Ji**, H.C. Liu, Y.L. Li, (2020) Large-scale Early Cretaceous lower-crust melting derived adakitic rocks in NE China: implications for convergent bidirectional subduction and slab rollback. *International Geology Review*. doi:10.1080/00206814.2019.1697968

FORTHCOMING

CONFERENCE ABSTRACTS

16. **D. Ji,** R. Dasgupta, 2026. A garnet-clinopyroxenite mantle source for young lunar basalts. *2026 AGU Annual Meeting* submitted

15. N. Dygert, **D. Ji**, M. Mouser, 2026. Crystal-chemical and temperature-dependent effects on Eu partitioning behavior and their importance for constraining redox conditions. *ExPet26 meeting, Carnegie Institution of Washington.*
14. **D. Ji,** R. Dasgupta, C. Lee, 2026. Was the lunar mantle ever water-enriched? New insights from magmatic recharge model. *Inner Solar System Workshop, Rice University*.
13. **D. Ji,** R. Dasgupta, C. Lee, 2025. Water-depleted mantle source for the water-enriched lunar magma suggested by the effects of magmatic recharge. *2025 AGU Annual Meeting* V21B-0065.
12. N. Dygert, E. Etheridge, R. Huk, **D. Ji,** 2025. Applications of a new Eu-in-plagioclase-clinopyroxene oxybarometer. *Goldschmidt Conference* #27264.
11. **D. Ji,** R. Dasgupta, 2025. The Existence of Garnet in the 2-Billion-Year-Old Lunar Mantle Indicated by High Pressure-Temperature Experiments and Trace Element Modeling. *Lunar and Planetary Science Conference, LVI* #1332.
10. N. Dygert, **D. Ji,** E. Etheridge, 2025. Toward a Clinopyroxene-Plagioclase Oxybarometer for Lunar and Terrestrial Cumulates: An fO_2-Dependent Predictive Model for Clinopyroxene-Melt Eu Partitioning. *Lunar and Planetary Science Conference, LV* #2419.
9. Y. Zhang, R. Dasgupta, **D. Ji**, C. Lee, Y. Peng, B. Charlier, Z. Jin, J. Chen, O. Namur, 2025. Mantle melting conditions in South Pole–Aitken basin. *Lunar and Planetary Science Conference, LVI* #2106.
8. **D. Ji,** R. Dasgupta, 2024. Deep Sulfur Cycle in the Young Lunar Mantle Constrained by High Pressure-Temperature Experiments on Sulfide Saturation of Chang'E 5 Mare Basalts. *2024 AGU Annual Meeting* P51E-3015.
7. **D. Ji,** N. Dygert, 2024. A New Europium in Apatite-Plagioclase Oxybarometer for Lunar and Terrestrial Cumulate Rocks and Meteorites. *Lunar and Planetary Science Conference, LV* #1240.
6. N. Dygert, **D. Ji,** E. Etheridge 2024. Toward a Clinopyroxene-Plagioclase Oxybarometer for Lunar and Terrestrial Cumulates: An fO_2-Dependent Predictive Model for Clinopyroxene-Melt Eu Partitioning. *Lunar and Planetary Science Conference, LV* #2419.
5. N. Dygert, **D. Ji**, 2023. Serial Processing of the Lunar Crust after the Magma Ocean Stage and a Depleted Bulk Moon: Insights from a Europium-in-Plagioclase Partitioning Model. *Goldschmidt Conference*, # 17023.
4. **D. Ji,** N. Dygert, 2023. New experimental constraints on REE partitioning between apatite and silicate melts and a temperature and composition-dependent predictive partitioning model. *Lunar and Planetary Science Conference, LIV* #1255.
3. **D. Ji,** N. Dygert, 2022. Serial processing after lunar anorthositic crust formation indicated by rare earth elements in plagioclase. *Lunar and Planetary Science Conference, LIII* #1229.
2. **D. Ji,** N. Dygert, 2021. Eu anomalies in lunar plagioclase reflect secondary processing by subsolidus reequilibration and introduction of a KREEP component. *Goldschmidt Conference*, #3219.
1. N. Dygert, **D. Ji**, A.L. Fagan, C.R. Neal, D.S. Draper, J.F. Rapp, T.J. Lapen, 2021. Petrogenesis of and subsolidus reequilibration within lunar ferroan anorthosites: Two demonstrations of a new fO_2-dependent model for plagioclase-melt europium partitioning. *Lunar and Planetary Science Conference*, LII, #2352.

TALKS

Sep 2026	**Guest Lecturer** on *The Structure of the Lunar Interior*, EEPS 462, Rice University
Jan 2026	Graduate Interdisciplinary Earth Science Symposia (GIESS) Talk, Rice University
Nov 2025	**Guest Lecturer** on *Trace Element Partitioning*, EEPS 322, Rice University
Mar 2025	56th Lunar and Planetary Science Conference, Houston
Feb 2025	Graduate Interdisciplinary Earth Science Symposia (GIESS) Talk, Rice University
Feb 2025	Lunch Bunch Talk in Geochemistry/Minerology/Petrology (GMP), Brown University **(Invited)**
Nov 2024	**Guest Lecturer** on *Radiogenic Isotope Geochemistry*, EEPS 322, Rice University
Sep 2024	Graduate Interdisciplinary Earth Science Symposia (GIESS) Talk, Rice University
Mar 2024	55th Lunar and Planetary Science Conference, Houston
Mar 2023	54th Lunar and Planetary Science Conference, Houston
Oct 2022	**Guest Lecturer** on *Optical Mineralogy*, GEOL 310, University of Tennessee

Mar 2022	53rd Lunar and Planetary Science Conference, Houston
Jul 2021	31st Goldschmidt Conference, Virtual

GRANTS

2023 – 2024	**MSA Grant for Student Research in Mineralogy and Petrology** Mineralogical Society of America $5,000 to Student PI: Ji

HONORS & AWARDS

2026	**Alison Henning Teaching Award**, Rice University ($1,000)
2025	**AGU Annual Meeting Travel Award**, Rice University ($500)
2025	**Torkild Rieber Award in Geology**, Rice University ($2,500)
2024	**Planetary Origins to Habitability Graduate Fellowship**, Rice Space Institute (one semester stipend + $2,000 research funds)
2024	**AGU Annual Meeting Travel Award**, Rice University ($500)
2023 – 2028	**The Chair's Fellowship**, Rice University ($10,000)
2023	**Virginia & James Bibee Graduate Student Professional Promise Award**, University of Tennessee ($500)
2023	**Excellence in Teaching by GTA's Award**, University of Tennessee ($500)
2023	**Member**, *The Honor Society of Phi Kappa Phi*
2023	**LPSC Meeting Travel Award,** University of Tennessee ($500)
2022	**Jimmy Walls Colloquium Presentation Award**, University of Tennessee ($500)
2022	**LPSC Meeting Travel Award** University of Tennessee ($500)
2020	**Li Siguang Outstanding Student Award** (¥15,000)
2020	**Excellent Senior Thesis Award**, Beijing
2020	**Dean's Nomination Award**, China University of Petroleum (¥5,000)
2019	**First-class Scholarship**, China University of Petroleum (¥2,000)
2018	**Oriental Geophysics Company Scholarship** (¥3,000)
2017	**Second-class Scholarship**, China University of Petroleum (¥1,000)

OUTREACH & SERVICE

2026-present	Outreach Project Coordinator, Houston Independent School District (HISD)-Rice University planetary project
2026	Inner Solar System Workshop Session Chair, *Volatiles, Differentiation, and Evolution of Rocky Bodies*
2026	Reviewer for Graduate Women in Science (GWIS) National Fellowship
2026	Rice K-12 Earth and Planetary Open House
2025	Invited talk on planetary differentiation presented in the professional development series for K–12 science teachers in Houston.
2024	Volunteer Judge for Outstanding Student Poster Award, AGU Annual Meeting

Journal Reviewer

Geochimica et Cosmochimica Acta × 3
Earth and Planetary Science Letter × 2
Geophysical Research Letters × 1
Icarus × 3
Lithos × 2
npj Space Exploration × 2
American Mineralogist × 1
International Geology Review × 2

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING & EXPERIENCE

Rice University

Fall 2025	EEPS 322: Chemistry of Earth and Planetary Materials, **Teaching Assistant**

2023 – Summer 2025	**Research Assistant**
University of Tennessee	
Spring 2023	GEOL330: Igneous and Metamorphic Petrology, **Teaching Assistant** Student evaluation 5.0 / 5.0
Fall 2022	GEOL310: Mineralogy, **Teaching Assistant** Student evaluation 4.8 / 5.0
2021 – 2022	**Research Assistant**
University of Texas at Dallas	
Summer 2019	**Visiting scholar** Supervisor: Robert J. Stern

SUPERVISION

2026	**Naidhruv Ananth Iyer** (Undergraduate, Rice University) Trace element partitioning experiments
Summer 2025	**Denim-Leenox Sasser** (High school intern) Garnet stability in the lunar mantle
Summer 2024	**Aahan Roy** (High school intern) Sulfur solubility of lunar basalts →Now a undergraduate student at UT Austin
2022 – 2023	**Jordan Marshall** (Undergraduate, University of Tennessee) Piston-cylinder experiments → Materials Engineering, University of Tennessee (PhD track)

FIELD EXPERIENCE

2025, 2023	**General field trip, New Mexico** A field trip of igneous and metamorphic rocks in New Mexico for a week led by Dr. Cin-Ty Lee and Dr. Rajdeep Dasgupta
2022	**Rio Grande Rift and Jemez Lineament xenolith sampling, New Mexico** Collected mantle and crustal xenolith from Kilbourne Hole to Cerro de Guadalupe in New Mexico for a week, led by Dr. Nicholas Dygert
2022	**McClung Blue Ridge Foothills Field Trip** Observed part of the transition from the external foreland fold-thrust belt of the Appalachians into the internal metamorphic core, led by Dr. Bob Hatcher
2019	**Archean Basic Rock Collection, Miyun** Collected Archean garnet pyroxenite and measured geological occurrence of basaltic dyke group, led by Dr. Huichuan Liu
2019	**Field Practice in Oilfield, Dagang Oilfield** Learned the working methods of oilfield engineers, and interpretation of seismic data as well as logging data for two weeks
2018	**Comprehensive Geological Field Practice, Liujiang Basin** A month-long geological field practice includes surveys of stratigraphic profiles and geological mapping, led by Dr. Liang Luo
2017	**General Field Practice, Western Hills of Beijing** A two-week geological field practice for learning magmatic, sedimentary, and metamorphic rocks, led by Dr. Qin Zhang

Last updated: Sep 2, 2026